

RARS Innoventa — Product Blueprint

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About this document. Everything describing the product is taken from a review of the actual code, database migrations and API routes. Anything not yet built is listed under Future Enhancements rather than written up as a feature.

Sections that would normally carry market data — competitor capabilities, pricing figures, growth targets — do not carry invented numbers here. Where a figure would be needed, the document says what has to be researched instead of filling the gap with something that looks authoritative but is not.

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1. Executive Summary

RARS Innoventa is a B2B wholesale marketplace built for Indian trade. A wholesaler lists what they stock. A retailer finds them, compares them against other wholesalers selling the same product, places an order, pays by UPI, and watches the consignment move on a map until it arrives.

Most of that already works. The platform handles listings, supplier comparison, single-wholesaler orders with multiple items, UPI payment collection, GST tax invoices with proper CGST/SGST/IGST treatment, delivery tracking, in-app chat and verified-purchase reviews.

Two things make it different from a directory. First, the order is a real transaction with money and paperwork attached, not a lead handed off to a phone call. Second, prices are recalculated on the server at checkout, so what the retailer pays is what the wholesaler actually listed.

The product is not finished. There is no admin interface, the order lifecycle cannot yet be advanced past payment from the UI, and the credit ledger that would let a retailer pay part now and part later has not been built. Those are covered in Section 16.

2. Introduction

How Indian wholesale works

Indian retail runs on a long chain. A manufacturer sells to a distributor, the distributor sells to a wholesaler, and the wholesaler supplies the neighbourhood kirana, the chemist, the hardware shop, the garment store. Most of these businesses are small, family-run, and have been trading with the same two or three suppliers for years.

The relationships are the business. A retailer stays with a wholesaler because that wholesaler answers the phone at nine at night, sends stock on credit before a festival, and takes back what did not sell. None of that is written down anywhere.

Why digitisation is picking up

Three things changed at roughly the same time. UPI made small-value business payments instant, so a retailer can pay a wholesaler without either of them visiting a bank. GST made invoicing a legal requirement rather than an optional courtesy, which pushed even small traders towards keeping records. And smartphones reached the shop counter, so the person running the business is already comfortable working on a screen.

Why B2B commerce is harder than B2C

A consumer buying a phone case wants speed and a good price. A retailer buying stock wants something else entirely.

B2C shopping	B2B wholesale buying
One or two units	Minimum order quantities, often 50 or 100+
One fixed price	Price depends on quantity, relationship, season
Pay now, always	Part payment, credit, settle next order
Buy once, move on	Same supplier every month for years
Receipt is optional	GST invoice is a legal and accounting necessity

A platform that treats wholesale like a bigger version of retail shopping will get the important parts wrong. That is the starting assumption behind this product.

3. Problem Statement

What the retailer deals with

A shop owner who wants to restock has to work the phone. They call the two wholesalers they know, ask what today's rate is, and take whatever they are told. There is no easy way to check whether a third wholesaler two districts away is selling the same thing for less, because there is no list to check.

Once the order is placed, it disappears. The retailer does not know if it has been packed, if it has left, or when it will arrive. They call to ask, and get told it is on the way. Stock planning becomes guesswork.

Payment and paperwork are equally loose. Money moves over UPI or in cash, and the invoice, if it comes at all, arrives later as a photo of a handwritten bill. At GST filing time, someone has to reconstruct months of this from memory.

What the wholesaler deals with

The wholesaler's problem is the mirror image. Their customer base is whoever happens to know them. Growing means physically travelling to new markets or paying for a listing on a directory that delivers phone numbers rather than orders.

They spend a large part of the day repeating themselves on the phone — quoting rates, confirming stock, chasing payment. Every one of those calls is a transaction that could have been a form.

They also carry real risk. Stock goes out on trust, and payment comes in later, if it comes. There is no record of who pays reliably and who does not, other than what they remember.

What both sides lose

Problem	Cost to the business
No price visibility	Retailers overpay; good wholesalers cannot prove they are cheaper
No order visibility	Retailers hold extra stock as a buffer, tying up cash
Paperwork after the fact	GST filing is painful and error-prone for both sides
Trust is undocumented	A good payment record is worth nothing to a new supplier
Everything runs on calls	The working day is consumed by coordination, not selling

4. Where Existing Platforms Fall Short

There is no shortage of B2B platforms in India. The gap is that most of them solve only one slice of the problem.

Directories stop at the introduction. IndiaMART and TradeIndia are built around helping a buyer find a supplier, then handing over contact details. Everything after that — negotiation, order, payment, invoice, delivery — happens off-platform with no record. The platform earns from the introduction, so it has little commercial reason to follow the transaction further.

Managed marketplaces take over the relationship. Udaan operates a buy-and-resell model. That makes the experience consistent, but it puts the platform between the wholesaler and their customer. The wholesaler becomes a supplier to Udaan rather than a business with its own customers.

Storefront tools assume you already have customers. Shopify and similar products are good for running your own shop, but they are not a marketplace. A wholesaler using one still has to find every buyer themselves.

Informal trade credit is largely unserved. Goods now, part payment now, balance against the next order is how a great deal of this trade actually settles. Traders keep doing it in a paper khata alongside whatever platform they use.

5. Vision and Mission

Vision

To make wholesale trade in India work the way retail already does: you can see what things cost, you can see where your order is, and you have the paperwork when you need it.

Mission

To reduce the distance between wholesalers and retailers. Practically, that means:

- Letting a retailer compare real suppliers on real numbers before ordering
- Making every order produce a proper GST invoice without extra work
- Showing the retailer where their consignment is, without needing a driver app
- Keeping the wholesaler's customer relationship theirs, not ours
- Eventually putting the credit that already happens informally onto a record both sides can trust

6. About Our Product

RARS Innoventa is a marketplace with two connected sides.

The buying side

A retailer browses by category or search. Products are shared entities — one "Steel Bolt" record that several wholesalers sell against. When a retailer opens a product, they see every wholesaler offering it side by side, with price, minimum order quantity, stock, shipping days, rating and orders delivered.

They pick a supplier, set a quantity, and check out. An order can hold several products but only from one wholesaler, because one order should mean one consignment on one truck. Payment is a UPI QR generated from that wholesaler's own UPI ID, so money goes directly from retailer to wholesaler.

After paying, the retailer can follow the delivery on a map and download the GST invoice from the order page.

The selling side

A wholesaler gets a separate workspace, styled differently from the storefront so it reads as its own tool. They list products, manage stock and pricing, see incoming orders, raise and track invoices, run GST and ageing reports, and message buyers.

The workspace is restricted to wholesalers. Retailers cannot open it, which is why anything a retailer needs — their orders, their invoices — lives on the buying side instead.

Who it is built for

Small and mid-sized Indian wholesalers who want more customers without giving up control of their pricing, and independent retailers who are tired of buying blind. It assumes both parties are comfortable with UPI and WhatsApp.

7. Product Objectives

Objective	What it means concretely
Make prices comparable	Show every supplier for a product on one screen with the numbers that matter
Make the order a real record	Server-side pricing, stock checks, line items, an audit trail
Remove invoice work	A GST invoice is generated automatically from the order
Make delivery visible	Track a consignment without asking the driver to install anything
Keep the relationship direct	Payment goes wholesaler to retailer; we do not sit in the middle
Build a usable trust record	Verified-purchase reviews and delivered-order counts, not invented scores

On the last point: the product previously showed a "trust score" and a "response rate" that were never calculated anywhere in the code. Every seller displayed the same default value permanently. Both were removed and replaced with figures counted from real orders and reviews.

8. Target Audience

Segment	Who they are	What they need	Supported today
Wholesalers	Small to mid-sized traders supplying a district or region	More customers, fewer phone calls, automatic invoicing	Full
Retailers	Kirana stores, chemists, hardware and garment shops	Price comparison, order visibility, proper bills	Full
Distributors	Sit between manufacturer and wholesaler; buy and sell in bulk	Both sides of the platform in one account	Partial
Manufacturers	Sell direct to wholesalers, in large lots	Bulk listings, dealer and territory management	Not specifically

Distributors are served by the both role, which lets one account buy and sell, with purchases and sales kept separate. Manufacturers can list as wholesalers, but there is no dealer or territory management built for them.

9. Solution

Each problem in Section 3 maps to something specific in the product.

Problem	What we do about it
No way to compare prices	One product, many suppliers, side by side with price, MOQ, stock, shipping, rating, orders delivered
Orders vanish after placement	A status trail on every order, plus a live map from warehouse to destination
Invoices are an afterthought	A GST invoice is raised when the order is placed and settled when payment lands
Everything runs on phone calls	In-app chat over websockets, with a WhatsApp fallback
Prices manipulated at checkout	The server re-prices every line against live inventory and ignores the client's amount
Overselling	Stock deduction is a guarded update that fails rather than going negative
Trust is undocumented	Reviews restricted to verified buyers; delivered-order counts computed from real orders

10. Core Features

10.1 Authentication and Access

Registration captures name, email, phone, password and a role. Passwords are hashed with bcrypt. Sessions are JWTs carrying the user id and role.

There are three roles. A buyer shops, a seller sells, and both does either. A buyer who wants to start selling can upgrade through a dedicated endpoint, which moves them to both rather than replacing their history.

The seller workspace is guarded on the route and again on every API call. A retailer who reaches a seller URL is redirected with an explanation instead of being shown a broken page.

Why it matters. Roles decide what someone sees, so they have to be right. An earlier bug treated a 403 as a dead session and logged users out mid-browse; now only a genuine 401 clears the session.

10.2 Vendor Management

Each wholesaler has a business profile: company name, GSTIN, contact phone, city, UPI ID and warehouse address with state and pincode. The warehouse is stored on the business rather than per product, because deliveries leave from the same yard regardless of what is in the box.

Public wholesaler profiles show verification status, years in business, city, orders delivered, rating, review count and the full catalogue.

Why it matters. A retailer buying from someone they have never met needs something to go on. Everything shown is either declared by the wholesaler or counted from real activity.

10.3 Product Management

Products are shared. When a wholesaler lists an item, they either attach to an existing product or create a new one, then add their own listing against it with their price, bulk price, MOQ, stock, shipping days and image.

This is what makes comparison possible — several wholesalers against one product rather than many near-duplicate listings. A database constraint prevents a wholesaler listing the same product twice; they are asked to edit the existing listing instead. Images upload directly to Cloudinary from the browser.

Why it matters. Without a shared catalogue, comparison is impossible and search returns the same item many times over.

10.4 Inventory

Stock, MOQ, price and status live on the listing. The seller dashboard reports active listings, total stock value, items out of stock, and items that have fallen below their own MOQ — a listing nobody can order from is as good as unavailable.

Stock is deducted when an order is placed, and returned if payment never completes, so abandoned checkouts do not quietly consume inventory.

Why it matters. An accurate stock number is the difference between a confirmed order and an apology.

10.5 Pricing

Each listing carries a standard price and an optional bulk price that applies once quantity reaches the MOQ threshold. The wholesaler sets both.

The important part is where pricing is decided. At checkout the server looks up every line against live inventory and recalculates the total. Any amount sent by the client is ignored.

Why it matters. This closes the most obvious way to attack a marketplace. It also means a price change between adding to cart and paying is handled correctly rather than silently honoured.

10.6 Orders

An order can contain several products but only from one wholesaler. Attempting to mix suppliers is rejected. One order means one consignment.

Every order writes line items, a delivery address with optional map-pinned coordinates, and a status history entry. The lifecycle is a 22-state machine with validated transitions, so an order cannot jump from placed to delivered.

Current limitation. The API to advance status exists and is correct, but no screen calls it. In practice an order stops at `payment_completed`. This is the most significant gap in the product today, and it is covered in Section 16.

10.7 Payments

Payment is UPI, direct between the two businesses. The platform generates a QR from the wholesaler's own UPI ID with the amount and order reference pre-filled. The retailer scans it in any UPI app, pays, and confirms on the platform.

There is no payment gateway. Money never passes through us, which means no settlement delay for the wholesaler and no gateway fee on either side.

The trade-off is that payment is currently self-declared by the buyer. The wholesaler is not yet asked to confirm receipt. That confirmation step is the prerequisite for the credit system.

Why it matters. UPI is how this trade already settles. Forcing a gateway in between would add cost and delay for no benefit.

10.8 Invoicing and GST

Every order produces a proper tax invoice.

Element	How it works
Numbering	Sequential per year, with a prefix each wholesaler configures
Tax split	CGST and SGST within a state, IGST across states, resolved by state not city
Line detail	HSN code, quantity, unit price, GST percent, tax and line total
Both parties	Names, GSTINs and contact details for supplier and buyer
Payment	UPI QR embedded in the PDF, and a PAID / UNPAID / CANCELLED watermark
Defaults	Payment window, tax rate, notes and terms, saved per wholesaler
Reporting	GST summary and receivables ageing buckets
Export	CSV, Excel and a PDF summary, all matching the filters on screen

There is exactly one invoice per order, issued by the seller. The buyer downloads that same document from their order page.

Why it matters. This is the part that turns an informal transaction into a record both sides can file. It is also the feature most likely to bring a reluctant trader onto the platform, because it removes work they currently do by hand.

10.9 Delivery Tracking

Tracking is built around what exists on the ground. Most delivery in this trade is done by a driver in a hired vehicle who is not a platform user and will not install an app.

So the wholesaler generates a link and sends it over WhatsApp or SMS. The driver opens it in whatever browser their phone has and taps once to share location. The page reports position while it stays open. No account, no app, no background permission. Links are scoped to one order and expire.

The wholesaler can also add checkpoints by hand, which covers the case where the driver does not use the link at all. The retailer sees a map with the warehouse, the checkpoints passed so far, the current position and the destination.

Why it matters. Any tracking design that depends on a driver app is likely to fail in this market. This one degrades gracefully — worst case, the wholesaler adds checkpoints manually and the retailer still sees progress.

10.10 Communication

Real-time chat runs over websockets, with unread counts and read receipts. Users cannot message themselves. For traders who prefer WhatsApp, a deep link opens a chat with the product details pre-filled. This is a link, not the WhatsApp Business API.

Notifications cover in-app and email. SMS, WhatsApp API and push have service code in place but stay inactive until credentials are configured.

10.11 Reviews and Ratings

Retailers can review products and sellers, but only for orders they have actually paid for. The check is enforced server-side against the order record. Reviews support helpful votes, seller replies and reporting. Ratings feed the supplier comparison and the wholesaler profile.

The eligibility rule is deliberately set at a paid order rather than a delivered one, because delivery cannot currently be marked in the product. Once order status controls ship, this should be revisited.

Why it matters. An open review system on a B2B marketplace becomes a competitive weapon quickly. Restricting it to real purchases is the minimum that makes it meaningful.

10.12 Seller Analytics

The dashboard shows revenue received over 30 days with a trend against the previous 30, value awaiting payment, distinct customers, average order value and buyer rating. Alongside that is a fulfilment pipeline and inventory health.

Every figure is computed from orders, inventory and reviews. Where there is no data — no previous period to compare against, no reviews yet — the product shows nothing rather than a zero that reads as failure.

10.13 Administration

This does not exist yet as a product surface. Admin-scoped API routes are in place for review moderation, notification broadcasts and promotion management, and the role is enforced. There is no admin interface of any kind.

Promotions are in the same position. Flash sales, coupons, loyalty points, referrals and gift cards all have working backends and database tables, and the client can read them, but creation is admin-only with no screen to do it from.

Both are covered in Section 16.

11. Unique Selling Points

The order is a transaction, not a lead. Directories introduce the two parties and step away. Here the order, the money, the invoice and the delivery all live in one place with one record.

Payment goes direct. UPI from retailer to wholesaler, no gateway, no settlement wait, no cut taken in the middle.

GST invoicing is real, not a receipt. Correct interstate treatment, HSN codes, per-seller numbering, ageing reports. Built for the filing, not just for the customer.

Tracking that does not need a driver app. A one-tap browser link and manual checkpoints, designed for how goods actually move here.

Comparison on facts we can stand behind. Orders delivered, verified-purchase ratings, live stock. The invented trust scores were removed rather than kept because they looked good.

The wholesaler keeps their customer. We do not buy and resell. The relationship, the pricing and the terms stay with the trader.

12. Competitor Positioning

The table below compares business models, which are a matter of public positioning. It deliberately does not compare features.

Platform	What it fundamentally is	Who pays it	Role in the transaction
IndiaMART	Supplier directory and lead engine	Suppliers, for leads	Introduces, then exits
TradeIndia	Supplier directory	Suppliers, for listings	Introduces, then exits
ExportersIndia	Export-focused directory	Suppliers, for listings	Introduces, then exits
Udaan	Managed B2B marketplace	Margin on goods	Buys and resells
Shopify	Storefront software	Merchants, subscription	Not a marketplace
RARS Innoventa	Transactional B2B marketplace	To be decided (Section 14)	Hosts the whole transaction

A feature-by-feature comparison is not included, and should not be produced without research. Asserting what each competitor does and does not support would require actually using their products or reading current documentation. Any such table written from memory would be unreliable, and unreliable competitor claims are worse than none — they get quoted in a pitch and then contradicted by someone in the room who uses the product.

Recommended next step. Sign up as a supplier and as a buyer on IndiaMART, TradeIndia and Udaan, and record what each one actually does at each stage: discovery, quoting, ordering, payment, invoicing, delivery, dispute. That produces a comparison that will survive scrutiny.

What can be said without research is structural. We are pre-launch. The established players have reach, mobile apps and operational tooling that we do not. The argument for this product is not scale; it is that it covers the part of the trade that a directory hands back to the phone.

13. Gap Analysis

Gap	Who leaves it open	How we address it	Status
Buyer cannot compare suppliers on identical goods	Directories	Shared product catalogue with side-by-side comparison	Built
Transaction happens off-platform, leaving no record	Directories	Order, payment, invoice and delivery recorded together	Built
Platform inserts itself between the two businesses	Managed marketplaces	Direct UPI, no reselling, wholesaler keeps pricing and terms	Built
GST paperwork is manual	Directories, storefront tools	Automatic tax invoice with correct interstate treatment	Built
Tracking assumes a driver app	Most logistics tooling	One-tap browser link plus manual checkpoints	Built
Reviews are gameable	Directories	Verified-purchase only, enforced server-side	Built
Informal trade credit has no record	Most platforms	Credit ledger with per-pair terms and no interest	Planned
Buyer self-declares payment	Ours	Wholesaler confirmation step	Planned
No operational tooling for the platform team	Ours	Admin console	Planned

The last three are our own gaps, not the market's. They are listed here so this section reads as a balance sheet rather than a sales pitch.

14. Business Model

The platform does not buy or hold stock, so revenue has to come from the service rather than a margin on goods. These are the options available to a product shaped like this one.

Stream	How it would work
Wholesaler subscription	Recurring fee for the seller workspace beyond a free listing tier
Transaction commission	A percentage on completed orders
Verification	Paid badge after checking GSTIN and business documents
Featured placement	Paid position in category and search results
Credit facilitation	Fee for underwriting or guaranteeing trade credit, once the ledger exists
Logistics partnerships	Referral share from transport partners booked through the platform

One constraint worth noting. Because payment goes directly between the two businesses over UPI, commission cannot be deducted at source. Collecting it means invoicing the wholesaler separately, which is harder to do before the platform is visibly generating orders for them.

That points towards leading with subscription and verification, both of which are collectable from day one, and introducing commission later. **This is a recommendation, not a decision, and no revenue split or projection has**

been modelled.

15. Pricing Strategy

No price points are proposed in this document, because there is no basis for them yet. Nothing in the codebase implies a price, and no wholesalers have been interviewed. Numbers written now would be guesses that later get treated as research.

What can be set now is the shape of the plan and the reasoning behind it.

Decision	Position	Reasoning
Retailer pricing	Free	Retailers are the demand side. Charging them would prevent the network forming
Free tier for wholesalers	Yes, genuinely usable	A crippled free tier means an empty catalogue, and an empty catalogue is worthless to retailers
What sits behind payment	Invoicing depth, GST and ageing reports, analytics, tracking	These replace work a wholesaler currently does by hand, which is the easiest value to argue for
Verification	Paid	It costs real effort to check a GSTIN and business documents
Tier structure	One free, two paid	Enough to separate a small trader from a larger one without becoming a pricing matrix

What has to happen before prices are set. Interview a sample of wholesalers across at least two categories and two cities. Find out what they currently pay for listings or leads, and what a month of the seller workspace would have to save them to be worth paying for. Price against that, not against a competitor's published rate card.

16. Future Enhancements

Listed in the order they should be built.

Near term — needed for the product to be complete

Order status controls. The single biggest gap. The API works; no screen calls it, so orders never move past payment. Several things are blocked behind it: the dashboard fulfilment pipeline, delivered-order counts on seller profiles, and the review eligibility rule, which had to be relaxed from delivered to paid to work at all. The plan is four actions — Accept, Packed, Dispatch, Delivered — each walking the intermediate states server-side so the wholesaler does not click through eight.

Wholesaler payment confirmation. Today the buyer declares payment and the system believes them. The wholesaler should confirm receipt. This is also the prerequisite for credit.

Admin console. The API routes and role checks exist; there is no interface. Needed for review moderation, promotion management and support.

Medium term

Trade credit ledger. Terms agreed per wholesaler-retailer pair, a down payment on delivery and the balance carried to the next order. No interest — the point is to formalise what already happens, not to lend. Warn when a limit is crossed at first, block later. Needs a retailer reliability score built from payment history.

Promotions interface. Flash sales, coupons, loyalty, referrals and gift cards are all built on the server with tables in place. They need screens.

Regional pricing. Prices varying by region based on demand. Currently a flat price with an optional bulk price. This needs care — the logic would have to be predictable enough that a wholesaler can tell what their customer sees.

Longer term

Enhancement	Why
Mobile apps	Most of this trade happens on a phone at a counter
Regional languages	English is a real barrier for a large part of the market
RFQ and negotiation	Large orders get negotiated; the product assumes list prices
Logistics integration	Book transport through the platform
GSTIN verification API	Automatic verification instead of manual document checks
Return management	Tables and an endpoint exist; no workflow or interface
Demand forecasting	Suggest restocking from order history

Engineering work not visible to users

There are no automated tests and no CI pipeline. The README is substantially out of date: it describes a Razorpay payment integration, a `models/` directory and several pages that do not exist in the codebase. Both should be fixed before the team grows.

17. Success Metrics

No targets are given below. The product has not launched, so any number here would be invented, and invented targets are worse than none because teams plan against them. What follows is what to measure and why it matters. Baselines should be taken from the first full quarter of live usage, and targets set from those.

The metric that matters most

Repeat order rate — the share of retailers who place a second order within 60 days. A wholesale marketplace lives or dies on repeat purchasing. One order can be curiosity; the second means something was actually solved.

Growth

Metric	What it tells us
Registered wholesalers	Supply depth
Registered retailers	Demand
Active listings	Whether the catalogue is worth browsing
Share of wholesalers with more than a handful of listings	Genuinely committed sellers, as opposed to sign-ups

Transaction health

Metric	What it tells us
Orders per month	Core volume
Repeat order rate over 60 days	Whether the product works
Average order value	Whether real restocking is happening, or only trial orders
Payment completion rate	How many started checkouts finish
Share of orders reaching delivered	End-to-end completion. Cannot be measured until order status controls ship

Quality

Metric	What it tells us
Average seller rating	Supply-side quality
Share of orders that receive a review	Whether the trust signal has enough data behind it
Disputes per hundred orders	Friction between the two parties
Invoice download rate	Whether the GST feature is genuinely used or merely present

Commercial

Metric	What it tells us
Free to paid conversion	Whether the paid tier is worth its price
Monthly recurring revenue	Predictable income
Subscription retention	Whether value persists past the first month
Gross merchandise value	Total trade flowing through the platform

18. Conclusion

RARS Innoventa sets out to do the part of wholesale trade that existing platforms leave to phone calls and paper. A retailer can compare real suppliers on real numbers, order from one of them, pay directly by UPI, watch the

consignment arrive, and download a GST invoice their accountant can use. A wholesaler gets customers beyond the ones they have personally met, without handing over their pricing or their relationships.

A good part of that is built and working: the marketplace, ordering with server-verified pricing, UPI collection, GST invoicing, delivery tracking, messaging and verified reviews.

The product is not finished. Orders cannot yet be marked delivered from the interface, which blocks several things behind it. There is no admin console. The credit ledger — arguably the most commercially important item on the roadmap, because it addresses a need most traders have and few platforms serve — has not been started.

None of those are hard problems. They are sequencing. The foundations that are difficult to change later — the data model, where pricing authority sits, and invoice numbering — are the ones that are already right.

The next milestone is straightforward: finish the order lifecycle, add wholesaler payment confirmation, then build credit on top of it.